headlines like this, especially at the onset of winter in the national capital. India is breathing bad air.

Released in October 2020, *The State of Global Air* report assesses air quality on three important parameters: people's exposure to $PM_{2.5}$ (which represents ambient outside air pollution), ozone exposure and indoor pollution. The report found a marginal decline in the global level of $PM_{2.5}$ exposure over the period 2010–2019. However, the presence of ozone has increased over this period. Likewise, the use of solid fuels in homes for cooking and heating, which is a primary reason for indoor pollution, has also declined globally.

India fares badly with respect to two of the three metrics: exposure to $PM_{2.5}$ pollution and increase of ozone. However, the country has done quite well in reduction of use of solid fuels in homes, although the proportion of households using solid fuels still continues to be quite high. In 2019, India had the highest population-weighted annual average $PM_{2.5}$ exposure in the world at 83.2 micrograms per cubic metre ($\mu g/m^3$) of air. WHO's safe limit for weighted annual average $PM_{2.5}$ exposure is only 10 $\mu g/m^3$. India was in the least healthy category of exposure, between 75 and 85 $\mu g/m^3$. Over the period 2010–2019, the country saw the third highest increase in exposure after Nigeria and Bangladesh at 6.5 $\mu g/m^3$ over this period; Nigeria had an increase of 7.5 $\mu g/m^3$. A number of countries saw decline in exposure during this period. India's general quality of air suggests a state of emergency.

We also fared poorly with regard to ozone exposure.

India performed well in handling indoor pollution. South Asia, which has the second highest use of solid fuels—coal, charcoal, wood, agriculture waste, animal dung and kerosene—in the world, recorded the largest decline in the proportion of households using solid fuels from 2010 to 2019, from close to 74 per cent in 2010 to about 60 per cent in 2019. In India, about 54 million households stopped using solid fuels to meet their cooking